

English Through Sitcoms

Learning language, logic, and sarcasm from
“The One with the Baby on the Bus”





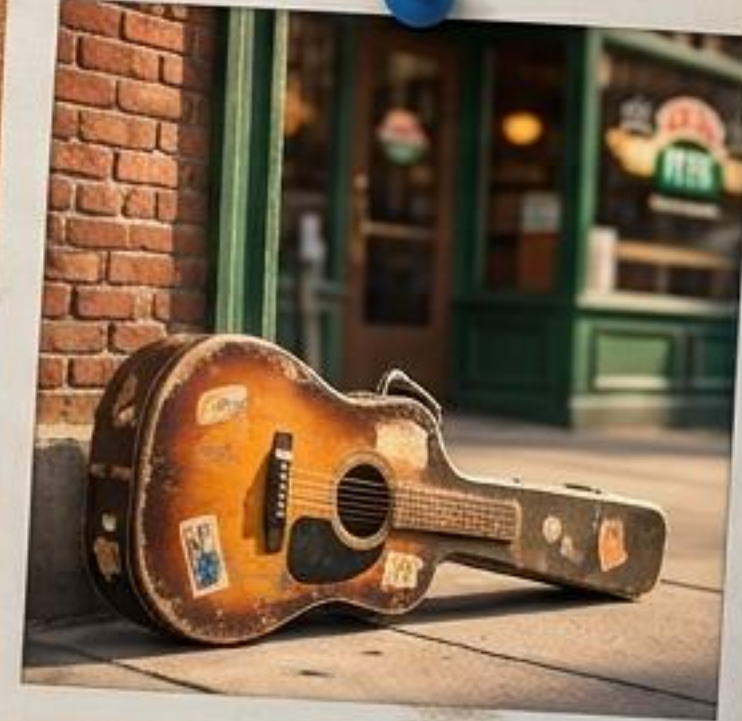
ROSS'S PIE-TASTROPHE!

Ross eats kiwi-lime pie, suffers an allergic reaction, and rushes to the hospital.



THE BEN & BUS INCIDENT

Joey and Chandler babysit Ben, use him to attract women, and accidentally leave him on a bus.



PHOEBE'S PROTEST JAM

Phoebe is replaced by a professional musician and protests outside the coffeehouse.

Medical Emergencies: Vocabulary

‘EMERGENCY’

Allergic reaction:

Ross's tongue swells up because he is allergic to kiwi, resulting in "intelligible unintelligible" speech.

HOSPITAL
HIST FORM

Name: _____ Date: _____
Address: _____
Phone: _____ Time: _____
Hospital of Origin: _____

Phobia:

An extreme fear. Ross is terrified of needles and begs for the medicine in a "squirt gun."

Bone bruise & Puncture wound:

The injury Ross gives Monica by squeezing her hand too hard while getting his injection.



MONICA

MEDICAL

Dating & Slang (Phrasal Verbs)



Pick up [someone]

To attract romantic interest.
Joey insists babies are magnets to pick up women on the street.



Break away

To separate from a group.
Joey hopes one of the women will break away to talk to them.



Make out

To kiss passionately.
Chandler sarcastically suggests they skip the baby next time and just make out with each other in the park.

Idioms of the Day

Get the ball rolling: To start something. Phoebe puts her own money into the guitar case to get the ball rolling and encourage others to tip.

Call it in the air: To guess the result of a coin toss while it is flipping. Chandler tells Joey to do this to decide which baby to take home.

Sloppy seconds: Taking something someone else rejected. Phoebe refuses to be a sloppy second, charity band after a professional plays.

A Tale of Two Disasters

Plot A: Joey & Chandler

The Goal

They want to use the baby to pick up women.

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The Obstacle



They get distracted and leave the baby on public transit.



The Outcome



Flipping a coin at the Department of Human Services to guess which baby is Ben.

Plot B: Phoebe

She wants to keep her Central Perk singing gig.



The manager hires a paid professional to replace her.

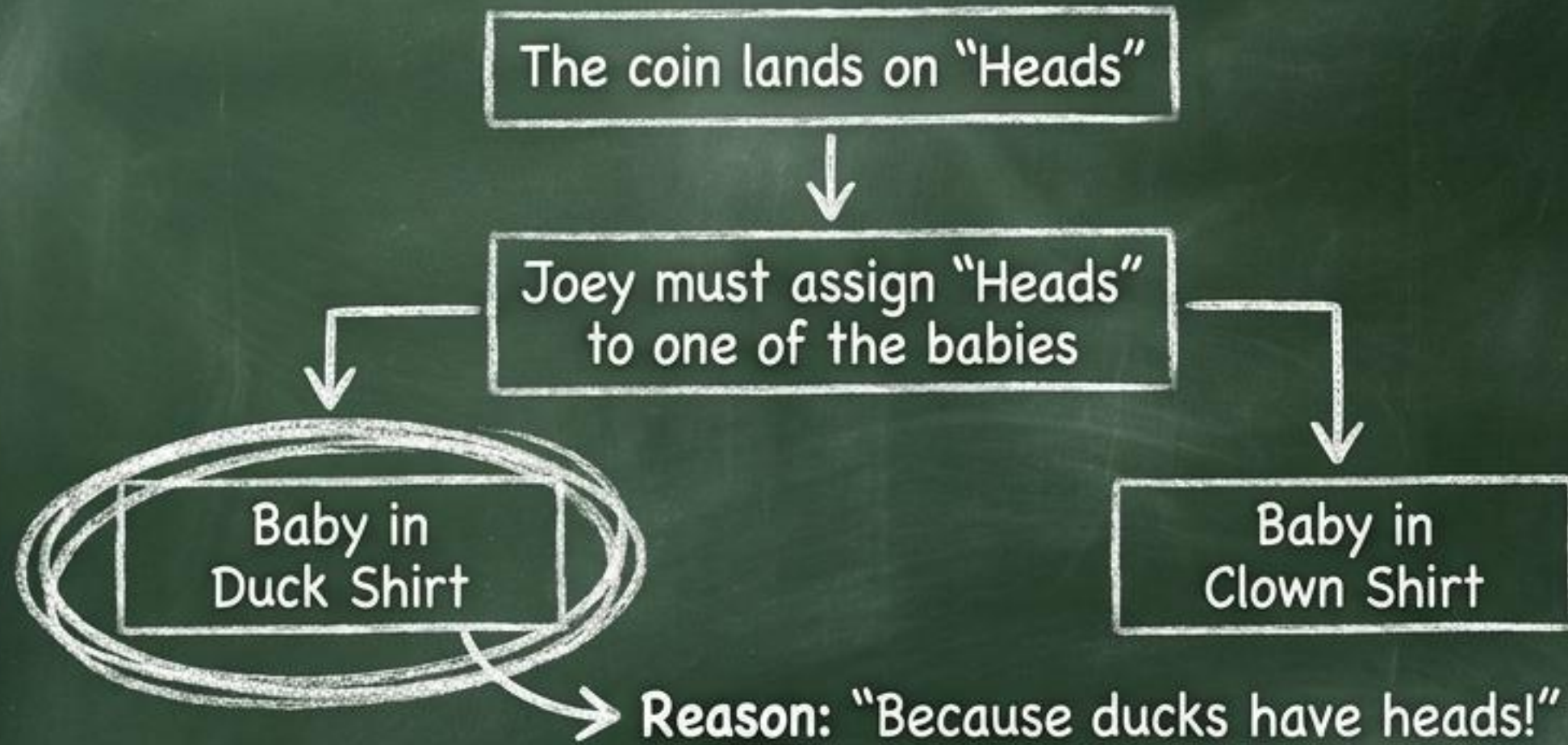


Singing "Smelly Cat" on the sidewalk for \$8.27 and a dropped condom.



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Decoding Joey's Logic



The Punchline: Chandler replies, "What kind of scary-ass clowns came to your birthday?"
(Highlighting the absurdity that clowns also have heads).

Understanding Sarcasm

The Situation:

Joey yells "Ben!"
at the departing bus.

Literal Meaning

The infant will understand
his name, reach up, and
signal the bus driver to
stop.

The Quote:

"Oh, that's good.
Maybe he'll hear you
and pull a cord!"
- Chandler

Intended Meaning (Sarcasm)

Yelling at a moving vehicle
is completely useless, and
Joey is being an idiot.

Comprehension Check

1. Ross was severely allergic to key lime pie. (True / False)
2. Chandler told the transit authority they were doing research for a book. (True / False)
3. Phoebe made exactly six dollars singing outside. (True / False)
4. Joey assigned "Heads" to the baby with the duck shirt. (True / False)

Comprehension Answers

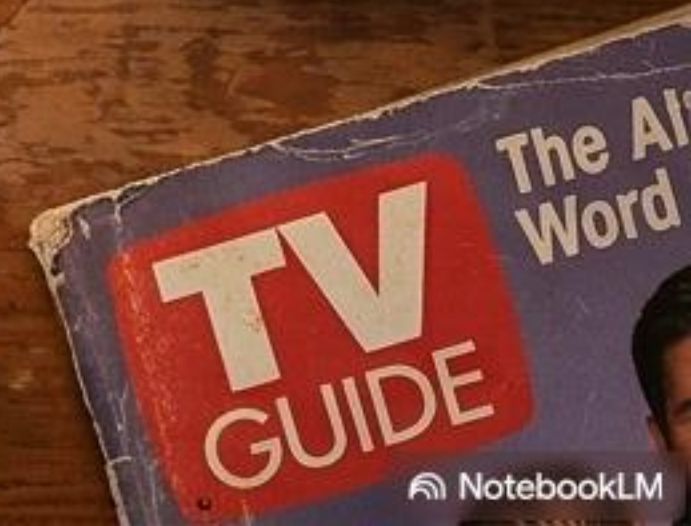
1. ☒ FALSE. He was allergic to Monica's kiwi-lime pie.
2. ☒ TRUE. Chandler used this excuse to avoid admitting they lost a baby.
3. ☒ FALSE. She made \$8.27 and a condom (and put the first \$2 in herself to get the ball rolling).
4. ☒ TRUE. He chose ducks "because ducks have heads."

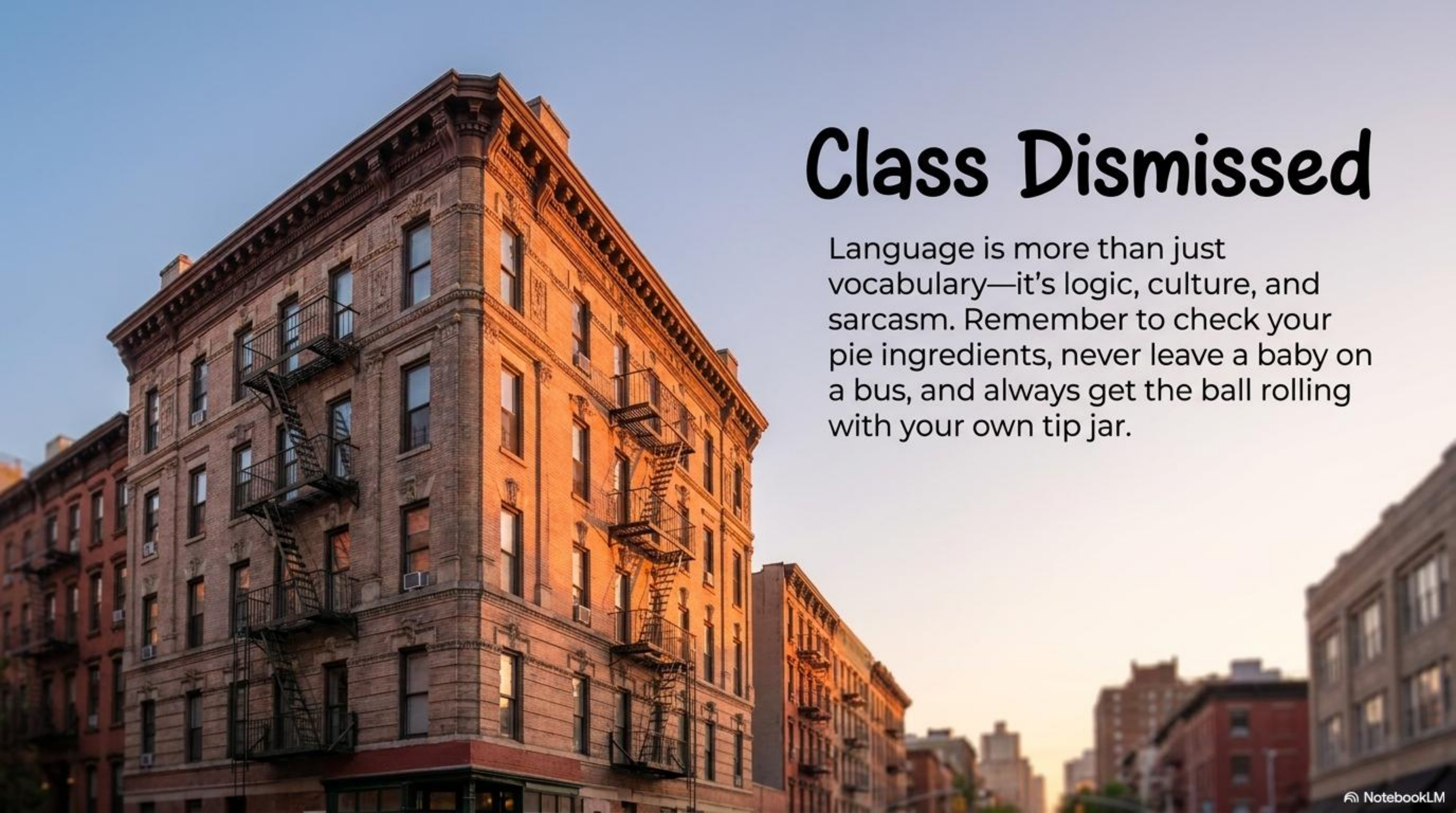
Speak & Write

Prompt 1: Have you ever made a huge mistake while taking care of something important? What happened?

Prompt 2: Do you agree with Phoebe's decision to refuse unpaid work at her own venue? Why or why not?

Prompt 3: In your own words, explain how Chandler and Joey finally got Ben back.





Class Dismissed

Language is more than just vocabulary—it's logic, culture, and sarcasm. Remember to check your pie ingredients, never leave a baby on a bus, and always get the ball rolling with your own tip jar.